



Gen 1 gets a spankin' new upgrade

ation of consoles. This included games like *Pokémon Pinball* for the *Game Boy Advance*, and *Pokémon Colosseum* for the *GameCube* among others.

Around this time, we would see the release of *Pokémon FireRed* and *LeafGreen*, which were remakes of *Pokémon Red* and *Green* for the *Game Boy Advance*. This would bring *Gen 1* up to *Gen 3* standards, and also add support for wireless connectivity. Eventually, *Game Freak* would also release *Pokémon Emerald*, which was meant to compliment *Pokémon Ruby* and *Sapphire*. It was an updated version with new features, including an altered plot, animated Pokémon sprites, and the *Hoenn Battle Frontier*. It would also introduce the ability to re-battle gym leaders. We would also see the national dex being introduced in *Pokémon FireRed*, *LeafGreen* and *Emerald*, which allowed for all of the 386 Pokémon out at the time to be acquired.

Before the fourth gen of Pokémon came out, we would see spin-off titles released on the new handheld console from Nintendo, the *DS*, including the



Gotta wrangle em' all!

popular *Pokémon Mystery Dungeon* games and *Pokémon Ranger*, which got nods in the anime as well. Both games were novel in the sense that you played as Pokémon in the *Mystery Dungeon* games and played as a Ranger and not a trainer in *Pokémon Ranger*, and used the stylus included with the *Nintendo DS* to catch Pokémon.

Gen 4 - It's only Gen 4?

Yeah, we're nearing the end of our pages and we're only on *Gen 4*, that's crazy. They've made a lot of these games. We'll try and keep it short to fit everything from here. *Diamond* and *Pearl* would release for the *Nintendo DS* in 2006, and would take trainers to the land of *Sinnoh*, a massive new place for trainers to explore with 107 new Pokémon to catch. These would be the first games to feature a pseudo-3D overworld, see the return of the time system which was absent in third gen games, visible gender differences



Pokémon Battle Revolution for the Nintendo Wii

in Pokémon, and also split Pokémon moves between physical and special moves. Remakes for the *Gen 2* games, *SoulSilver* and *HeartGold* would be released three years later on the *DS*.

Gen 5 - Still trying new things

Even though *Pokémon Black* and

White released on the *DS* like *Diamond* and *Pearl*, it looked like a next-gen game. The *Unova* region came with 156 new Pokémon, and none of the old Pokémon were available until the main storyline was completed, which was a first in the series. Further adding to the



Probably the best Pokémon plotline to date

time system, now we had seasons in the game too, with Pokémon distributed across various times of the day and different seasons. We also saw the introduction of triple battles for the first time.

Another first with *Gen 5*, was the release of two sequels, instead of the usual one which had been the norm with previous generations. Fans were assuming *Pokémon Grey*, but instead got *Pokémon White 2* and *Black 2*. Both games featured new Pokémon, changes to the plot and the region.

In conclusion (due to lack of pages really)

That covers Pokémon till around 10 years ago. In the 10 years since we've seen three new generations, including *Gen 6*, *7* and *8*, and the jump from the *Nintendo DS*, to the *3DS* and now to the *Nintendo Switch*, making it the first mainstream console to feature games from the main Pokémon RPGs. The grand total number of Pokémon as of writing this is 898, and we're sure that number will continue to grow larger. We expect it to hit the 1000 mark come Generation 9. What's your favourite Pokémon of all time? Write in to us at editor@skoar.in and let us know. My personal favourite is Shedinja. Check this article out online for more details!*